



Prime Minister Modi with UK Prime Minister Rishi Sunak

48 | There are international organisations like the UN who are focussing on all these issues. My focus is that we will steer our G20 presidency to build common positions on developmental issues that are of importance to the Global South.

**Q: You advocated vigorously for the African Union to be granted membership of the G20. What role do you see the African Union play in the G20 and could you share your vision about the role the African continent will play in shaping the new emerging world order?**

**A:** In October 2015, we had held a big India-Africa Summit in New Delhi. It was a massive effort where leaders from 54 countries of the African continent had come to India. It was a befitting occasion to bring out a special issue. Unfortunately, the media of our country did not understand the importance and uniqueness of that event. In fact, you should also look at as to how much coverage your magazine gave to that summit.

I am happy that at least now you have thought of the African Union and asked me this question.

I feel deeply for the countries of the Global South. It is my firm belief that we need to give importance to the developing world if we have to make progress on the global development agenda. If we give them a place of pride, listen to them, understand their priorities, they have the capacity and capability to contribute to global good.

When I was the Chief Minister of Gujarat, I had, for the first time, hosted the Summit of the Africa Devel-

opment Bank in Ahmedabad. It was also the first time they had held their meeting outside Africa. It was a great success.

This time, we decided to keep *Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam* as the motto of our G20 presidency. It is based on our fundamental belief and ethos.

**If we do not include developing countries, how can we realise *Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam*? How can there be One Earth, One Family, One Future?**

That is why, after taking over the presidency of G20, the first event that I held was the Voice of Global South Summit in January this year. After having listened to them, understanding their priorities and concerns, we set the agenda for our G20 presi-

dency. We have brought the priorities of the Global South onto the agenda of the G20, and we have made progress.

It is in this spirit that I have taken the initiative to make the African Union a permanent member of G20 during our presidency. I am confident that we will receive support to realise the same. This will make G20 more representative and give greater voice to the Global South.

A big threat to the world order emerges when countries feel that their views, concerns and issues are not taken in consideration in decision making.

It has been our conviction that without the voice and participation of the developing world, sustainable solutions to global challenges cannot be found.

Africa, in particular, has not been given its due recognition and place when it comes to institutions of global governance. India and Africa enjoy a very special relationship, and India has been a steadfast advocate of a greater role for Africa in global affairs.

**During our presidency of the G20, we have taken the initiative to seek a permanent seat for the African Union in the G20, and we believe that our proposal will enjoy the support of other G20 members.**

We believe that this step will empower the African continent to be able to better articulate their concerns and perspectives on the global stage, and play an important role in shaping the world order. **BT**

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